

Question 50 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Apply suitable training methods to design a development program for employees who need both practical job skills and conceptual knowledge.

Introduction

The learners need two kinds of learning at once. Conceptual knowledge is understanding — why a standard exists, what the principle is, how parts of the job connect. Practical skill is being able to do the task to a standard with one's hands, voice or software. One method rarely serves both well. Apply a blend: methods for the head, methods for the hand, a sequence, and evaluation of both.

Detailed points

- 1. Split the TNA into two lists of objectives.** Write conceptual objectives separately ('explain why lock-out is needed') and practical objectives ('perform lock-out on machine A in three minutes using the checklist'). Methods follow this split. If you mix them into one vague aim, you will lecture everything and practise nothing.
- 2. Methods for conceptual knowledge.** Short lectures, discussion, diagrams, caselets, e-learning modules, quizzes. Example: why a bank's KYC rule exists, not only which screen to click. Concepts travel to new situations; that is why they are needed along with skill.
- 3. Safe practice methods before live work.** Vestibule training, simulation, dummy machines, role play, lab. Mistakes here do not harm customers or equipment. This is the bridge from concept to the job. Off-the-job practice is especially important if the real task is dangerous or costly.
- 4. On-the-job coaching for real skill.** After simulation, OJT with a trained coach and a checklist. Job rotation if the practical skill has several contexts. The coach must be taught to teach; otherwise OJT copies bad habits.
- 5. Action-learning project to bind both.** A live but bounded problem where they must use the concept to decide and the skill to implement, then present what they learned. This prevents 'I understood in class but froze at work'.
- 6. E-learning as a refresher for concepts.** Short modules they can replay after OJT, when the concept starts to fade. Useful for mixed locations. Not a substitute for practice.
- 7. Sequence matters.** Recommended: concept → demonstration → simulated practice with feedback → OJT → review. Starting with unsupervised OJT may freeze wrong methods that later training cannot easily remove.
- 8. Evaluate both kinds of learning.** Knowledge tests for concepts (Kirkpatrick level 2). Observed job samples for skill (levels 2 and 3). If you only give a theory exam, practical skill may still be weak, and the programme has not met the brief.

Conclusion. Design a blended programme: conceptual methods (class/e-learning), safe practice (simulation/role play), then OJT coaching, plus an action project and dual evaluation. Suitable methods are a mix in a sensible sequence, not a single favourite of the trainer.